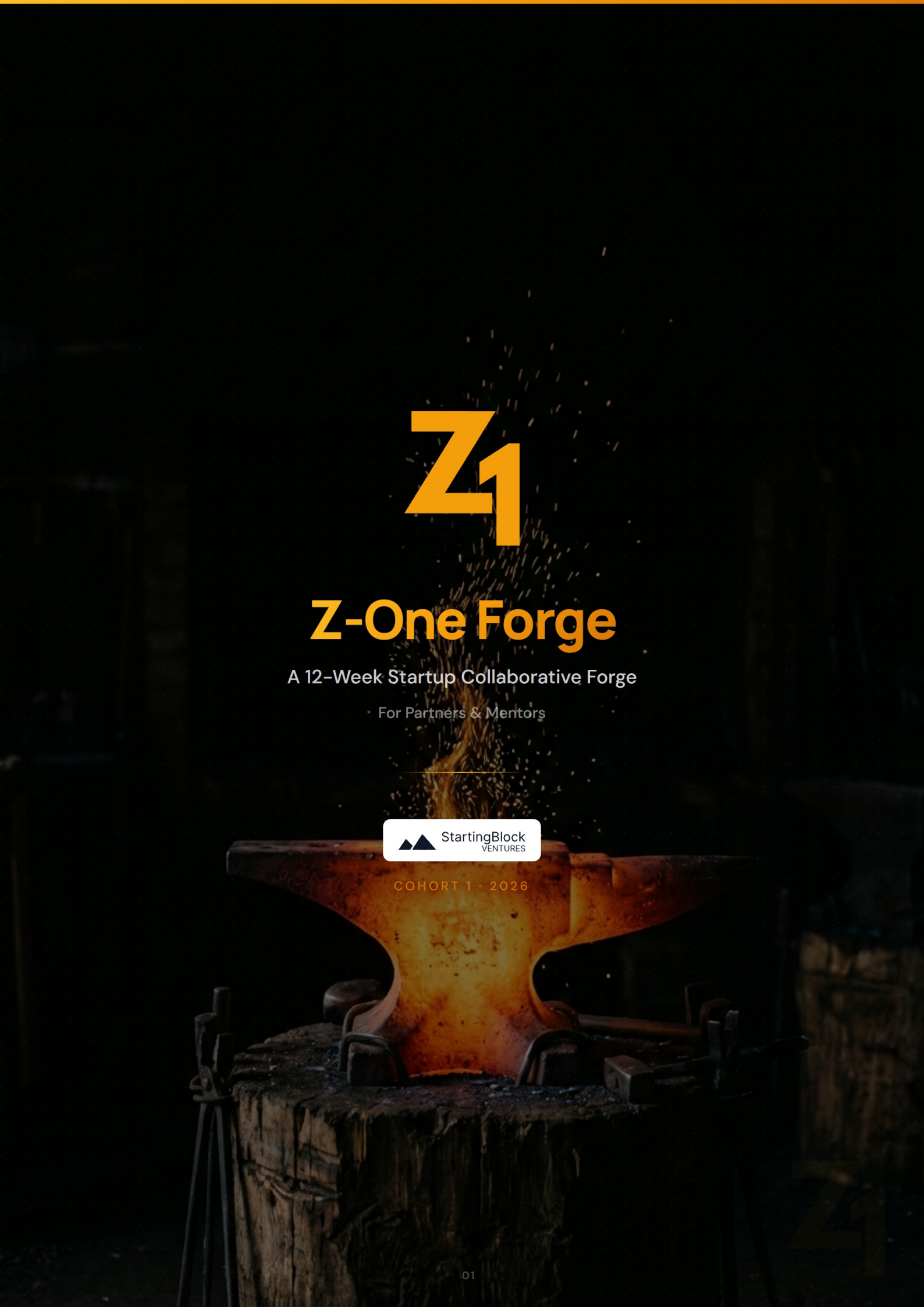


Z-One Forge

A 12-Week Startup Collaborative Forge

For Partners & Mentors

StartingBlock VENTURES

COHORT 1 · 2026

01 / EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Building the Future, One Ship at a Time

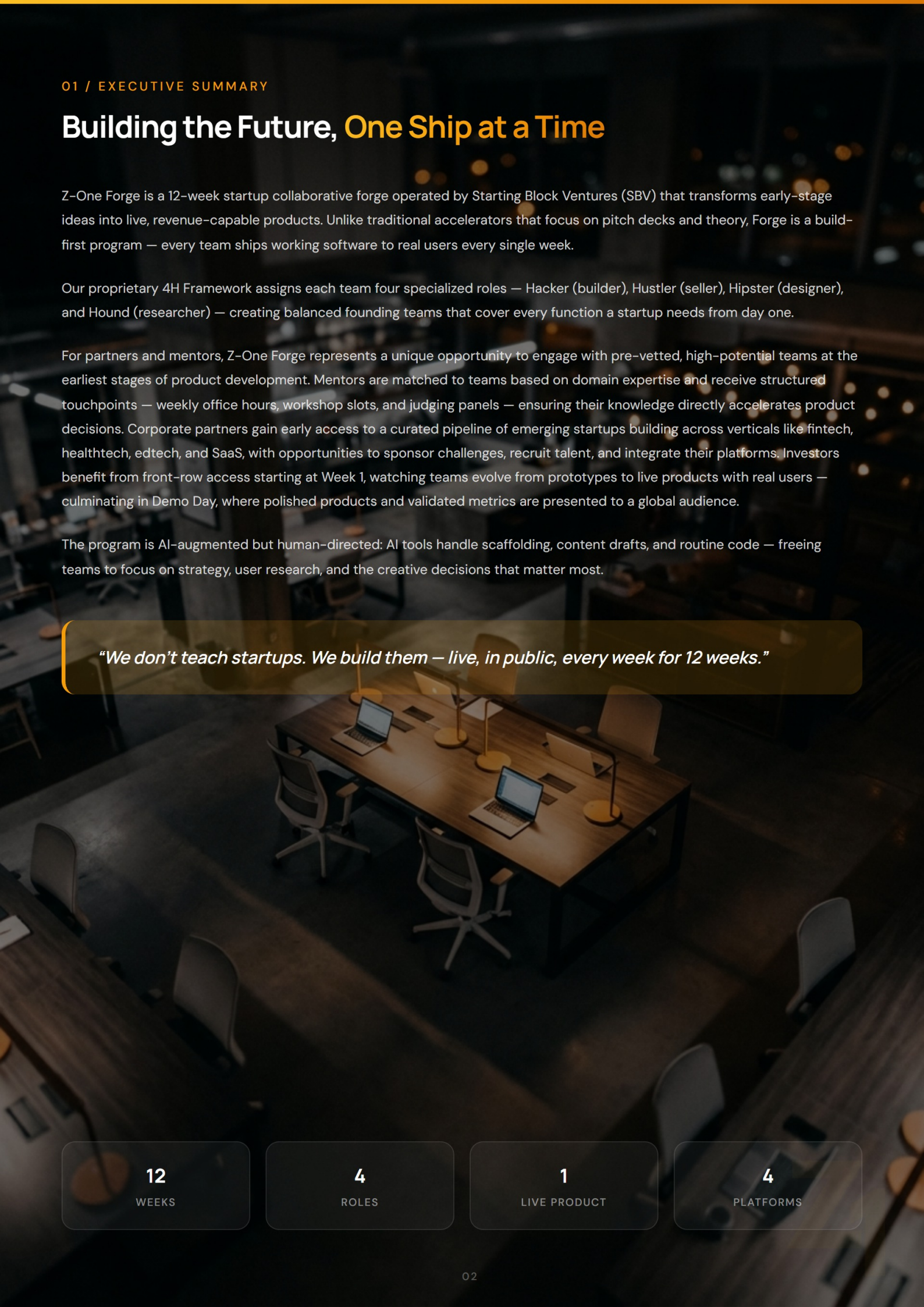
Z-One Forge is a 12-week startup collaborative forge operated by Starting Block Ventures (SBV) that transforms early-stage ideas into live, revenue-capable products. Unlike traditional accelerators that focus on pitch decks and theory, Forge is a build-first program — every team ships working software to real users every single week.

Our proprietary 4H Framework assigns each team four specialized roles — Hacker (builder), Hustler (seller), Hipster (designer), and Hound (researcher) — creating balanced founding teams that cover every function a startup needs from day one.

For partners and mentors, Z-One Forge represents a unique opportunity to engage with pre-vetted, high-potential teams at the earliest stages of product development. Mentors are matched to teams based on domain expertise and receive structured touchpoints — weekly office hours, workshop slots, and judging panels — ensuring their knowledge directly accelerates product decisions. Corporate partners gain early access to a curated pipeline of emerging startups building across verticals like fintech, healthtech, edtech, and SaaS, with opportunities to sponsor challenges, recruit talent, and integrate their platforms. Investors benefit from front-row access starting at Week 1, watching teams evolve from prototypes to live products with real users — culminating in Demo Day, where polished products and validated metrics are presented to a global audience.

The program is AI-augmented but human-directed: AI tools handle scaffolding, content drafts, and routine code — freeing teams to focus on strategy, user research, and the creative decisions that matter most.

> *"We don't teach startups. We build them — live, in public, every week for 12 weeks."*



12	4	1	4
WEEKS	ROLES	LIVE PRODUCT	PLATFORMS

02 / ABOUT SBV

From Service Provider to Ecosystem Architect

The venture studio behind Z-One Forge, and why we built it.

Starting Block Ventures (SBV) is a venture studio based in Makati, Philippines. Founded in 2024, SBV champions companies bold enough to reinvent how we live — across Fintech, Healthtech, SaaS, Climatetech, AI, and Consumer.

We evolved from being service providers to becoming ecosystem architects — building the infrastructure that helps founders thrive. Our reach extends across ASEAN and Greater China, connecting founders with global opportunities.

Z-One Forge is where that ecosystem starts. It's SBV's 12-week program where teams of four go from zero to one — a live, deployed product with real users and real revenue. Forge is the entry point into the broader SBV ecosystem: Mentors for guidance, Pitch for investor visibility, and InSpace for community.

OUR CORE VALUES

01 Merit-Driven

The best ideas win, regardless of background. Our selection focuses purely on potential and execution capability — ensuring partners engage with top-tier talent.

02 Co-Building

We don't just invest — we roll up our sleeves and build alongside founders. Partners and mentors become active collaborators, not passive observers.

03 Long-Term Partnership

Building great companies takes time. Relationships forged during the program extend into the alumni network, deal flow pipeline, and ongoing co-building.

04 Global Mindset

Rooted in the Philippines, thinking globally. Our network spans ASEAN, Greater China, and beyond — opening doors for partners seeking regional reach.

"The world has enough pitch decks. We build live products with real users, real revenue, and real teams — every cohort."

03 / WHY Z-ONE FORGE

Not a Mission Statement. A Reason to Exist.

The world has enough pitch decks and not enough live products. Here's why that matters for the partners and mentors who work with us.

PURPOSE

Builders deserve better than a pitch competition.

Most programs celebrate decks. We celebrate deploys. Z-One Forge exists because the best way to build a startup is to actually build one — with a real team, real users, and real deadlines. For mentors and partners, this means every team you engage with is actively building and shipping, not just theorizing.

NORTH STAR

Every builder in the Philippines ships their first product.

We're building the infrastructure for a generation of product-led founders. Not ideas on whiteboards — live products with paying users, launched by teams who learned by doing. Partners and investors gain access to a pipeline of founders who have already proven they can execute.

IMPACT

From "someday" to shipped.

Twelve weeks. One team. One product. By the end, teams have revenue, users, and a roadmap — not a certificate. The gap between 'I have an idea' and 'I have a company' shrinks every cohort, creating compounding value for every partner in the ecosystem.

MARKET SCOPE

Every niche. Every market.

Fintech, edtech, healthtech, logistics, AI tools, marketplaces, creator platforms, SaaS — partners access diverse deal flow across verticals.

Local problems. Global reach.

Teams solve local Philippine pain points or pursue worldwide audiences — partners tap into both emerging and global market opportunities.

Nobody builds alone.

The 4H framework means every team has builder, seller, designer, and researcher — giving partners confidence in team completeness.

A network beyond 12 weeks.

Z-One alumni stay connected — mentor access, investor introductions, and co-building opportunities continue long after Demo Day.

04 / VISION, MISSION & GOALS

Where We're Going. Why It Matters.

V Our Vision

To become Southeast Asia's premier startup forge — where the next generation of Filipino and ASEAN founders transform bold ideas into scalable, revenue-generating products that compete on the global stage.

M Our Mission

To equip aspiring founders with the structured framework, hands-on mentorship, AI-augmented tools, and collaborative environment they need to build, launch, and scale real products in 12 weeks — bridging the gap between raw potential and market-ready startups.

STRATEGIC GOALS & OBJECTIVES

01 Build Market-Ready Products

- Every team ships a live product with 50+ real users by Week 9
- Achieve first revenue or validated pricing before Demo Day
- Deliver investor-ready pitch decks with proven traction metrics

02 Develop Founder Talent

- Train 100+ founders per year through the 4H role specialization
- Build cross-functional skills: technical, commercial, design, and research
- Create a lifelong alumni network of builders across ASEAN

03 Strengthen the Ecosystem

- Connect 50+ mentors and industry experts to founding teams annually
- Establish corporate partnerships that generate deal flow and talent pipelines
- Position the Philippines as a launchpad for globally competitive startups

04 Scale Through Technology

- Integrate AI across every phase of the build cycle to 10x team output
- Build proprietary platforms (Forge, Mentor, Pitch, InSpace) that serve the full lifecycle
- Create reusable playbooks and toolkits that compound value across cohorts

05 / THE 4H FRAMEWORK

Four Roles. One Team.

Every team is built with four complementary roles that cover every function a startup needs — from code to customers.

Hk HACKER

The Builder + Code Owner

Writes the code. Owns architecture, APIs, deployment.

Hu HUSTLER

The Seller + Business Lead

Gets users, closes deals, tells the story.

Hp HIPSTER

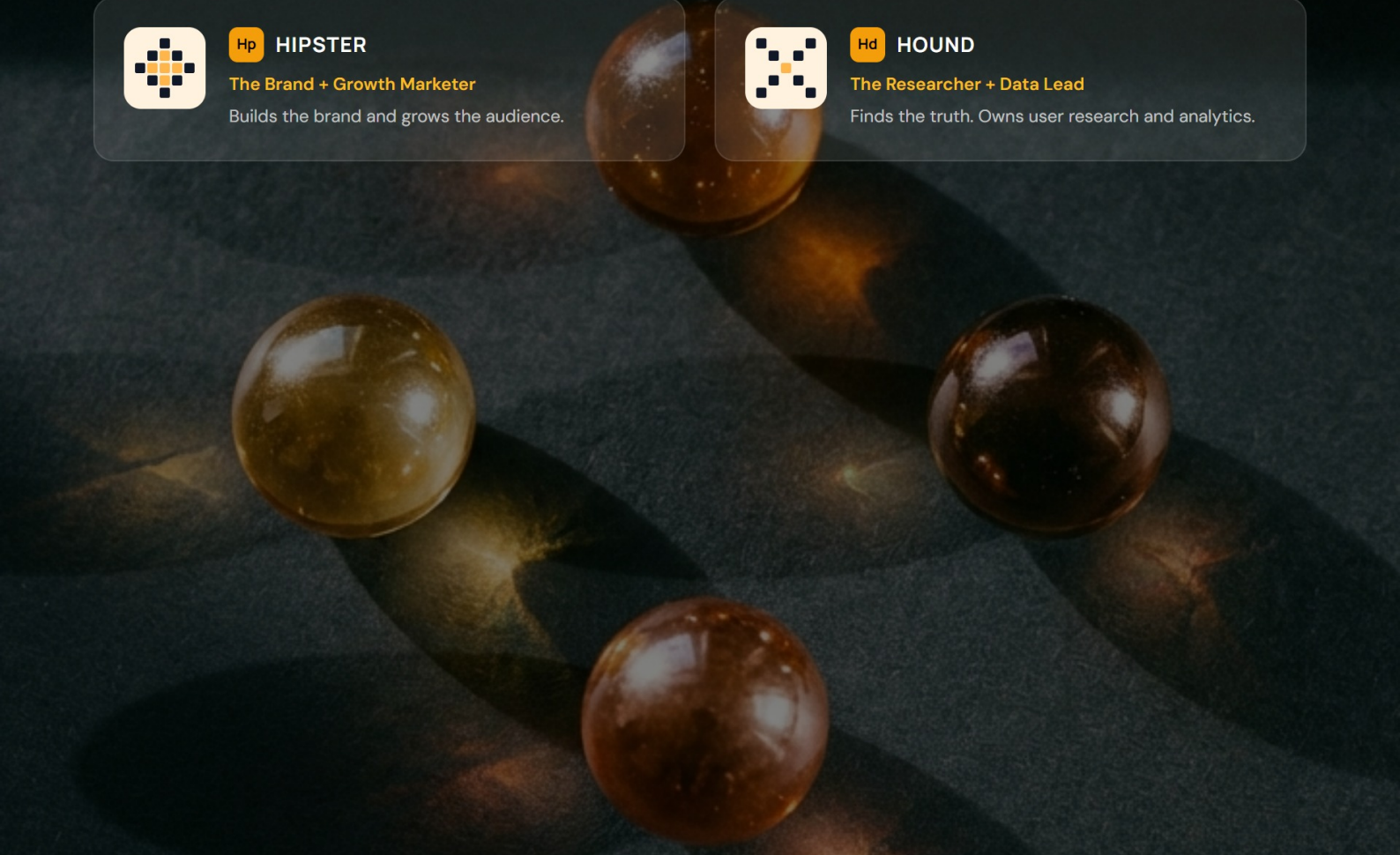
The Brand + Growth Marketer

Builds the brand and grows the audience.

Hd HOUND

The Researcher + Data Lead

Finds the truth. Owns user research and analytics.



COLLABORATIVE PAIRS

Hk × Hp The Product Pair
Weeks 1, 3, 4, 7, 8

Hk × Hd The Quality Pair
Weeks 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 10

Hk × Hu The Ship Pair
Weeks 1, 6, 9, 10

Hu × Hp The Growth Pair
Weeks 2, 6, 7, 9, 11–12

Hu × Hd The Strategy Pair
Weeks 4, 8, 10, 11–12

Hp × Hd The Empathy Pair
Weeks 2, 5, 6, 9

12 Weeks. 7 Phases.



01

Foundation — Week 1–2

- Landing page live
- Auth & dashboard scaffolded
- Team roles assigned

02

Core Build — Week 3–4

- Feature #1 & #2 shipped
- Data flow established
- First user feedback

03

Integration — Week 5–6

- 3rd-party APIs connected
- Notifications live
- Mid-program soft pitch

04

Polish — Week 7–8

- UX overhaul
- Security hardened
- Production deployment

05

Launch — Week 9

- 50+ real signups
- 10+ active users
- Public launch event

06

Scale — Week 10–11

- First revenue or validated pricing
- Pitch deck finalized
- Final feature ship

07

Demo Day — Week 12

- InSpace Pitch to global investors
- Graduation ceremony
- Alumni network onboarding

WEEKLY RHYTHM

M	T	W	F	S
Monday	**Tuesday–Thursday**	**Wednesday**	**Friday**	**Saturday**
Sprint Kickoff	Build, ship, collaborate	Mid-week Team Challenge	Feedback Friday	Weekly retrospective

07 / THE ECOSYSTEM

Four Platforms. One Ecosystem.

The SBV ecosystem connects teams, mentors, investors, and community through four purpose-built platforms.



Forge

z1.sbv.one

Intake, vetting, team matching, and progress tracking.

Mentor

mentor.sbv.one

Expert mentors on demand. Browse, book, and learn from the best.

Pitch

pitch.sbv.one

Pitch deck submission, investor visibility, and co-founder matching.

InSpace

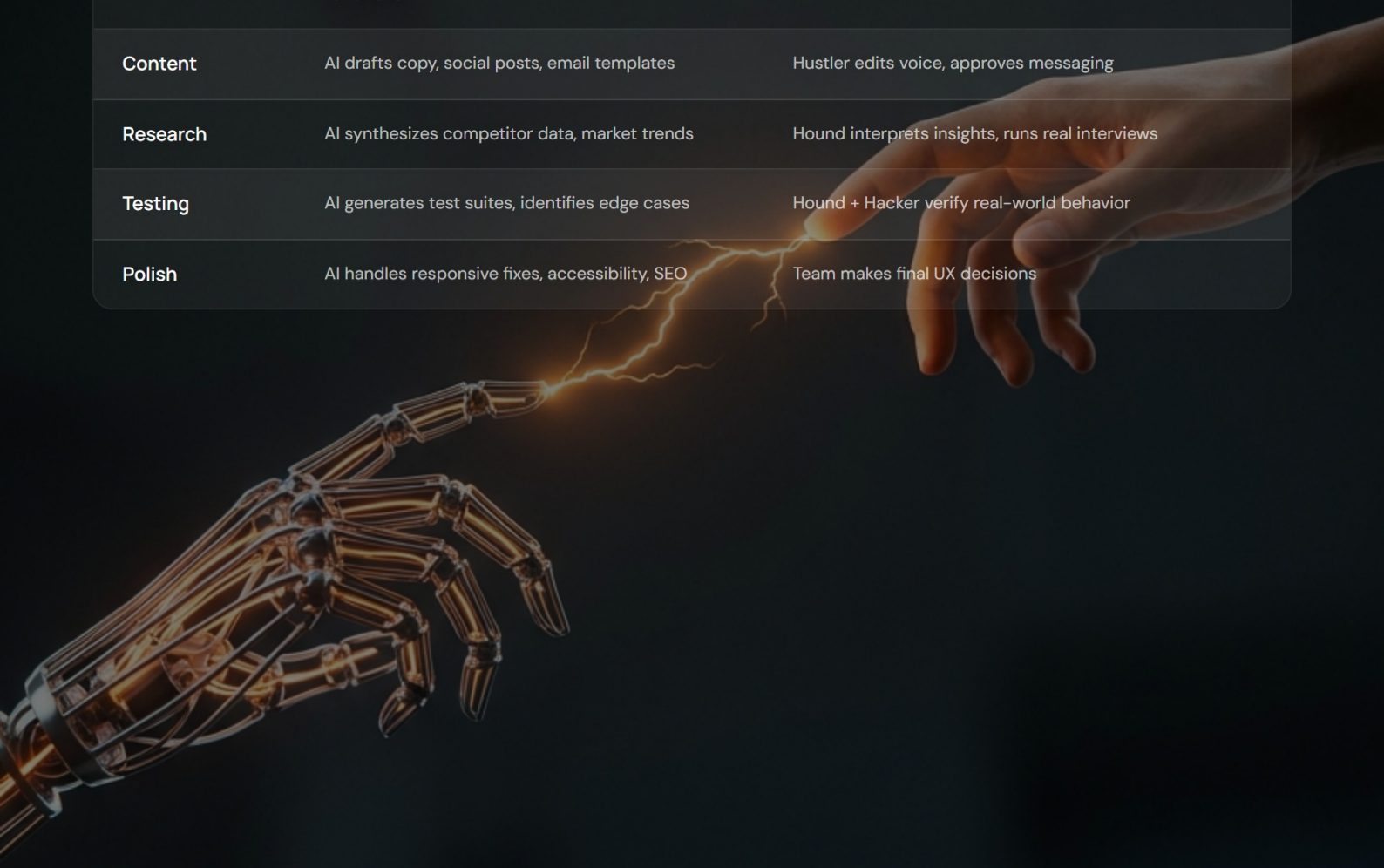
inspace.sbv.one

Community events — monthly Grit Chronicles, pitch nights, Breakpoints.live streams, and Demo Day.

AI-Augmented. Human-Directed.

AI handles the heavy lifting across every stage of product development. Humans make the decisions that matter.

STAGE	AI ROLE	HUMAN ROLE
Scaffolding	AI generates project structure, configs, boilerplate	Team defines architecture decisions and tech choices
Feature Building	AI pair-programs CRUD, API routes, UI components	Hacker reviews, tests, and owns the merge
Design	AI generates UI layouts, color palettes, component variations	Hipster directs brand vision, selects final designs
Content	AI drafts copy, social posts, email templates	Hustler edits voice, approves messaging
Research	AI synthesizes competitor data, market trends	Hound interprets insights, runs real interviews
Testing	AI generates test suites, identifies edge cases	Hound + Hacker verify real-world behavior
Polish	AI handles responsive fixes, accessibility, SEO	Team makes final UX decisions



AI does the heavy lifting. Humans make the decisions.

09 / INSPACE & COMMUNITY

Where the Community Comes Alive

Founder firesides, live pitch nights, and streamed challenges that turn a remote build sprint into a shared experience — and give partners direct visibility into the community.

GC

Grit Chronicles Monthly

Intimate fireside chats with successful founders sharing their raw, unfiltered journeys — the struggles, pivots, and breakthroughs that shaped their companies.

Partner opportunity: Guest speaker slots, brand visibility, and direct access to the founder community.

BP

Breakpoints.live

Broadcast layer for challenges and community moments — mid-week challenges livestreamed so the broader SBV community watches, engages, and participates.

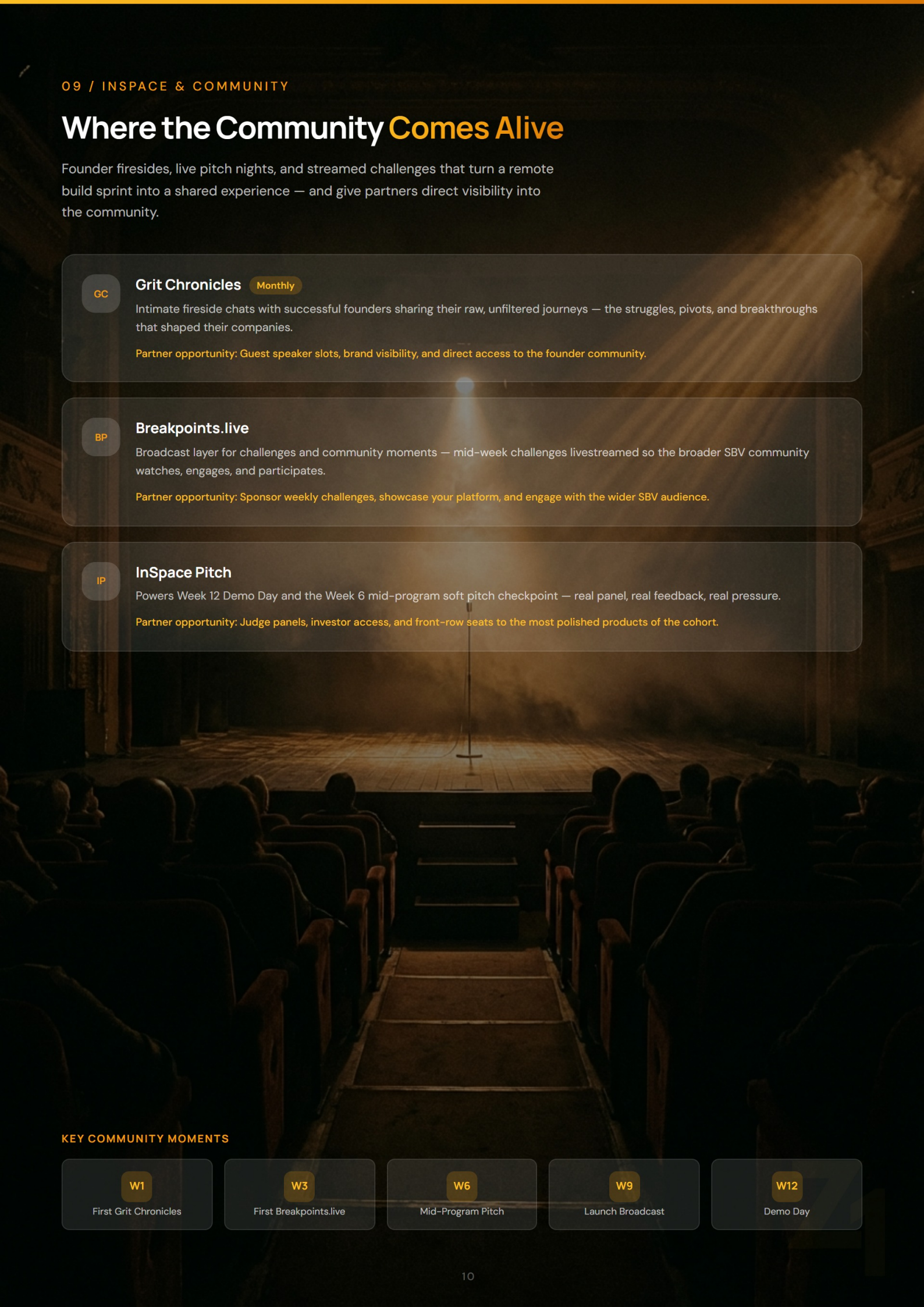
Partner opportunity: Sponsor weekly challenges, showcase your platform, and engage with the wider SBV audience.

IP

InSpace Pitch

Powers Week 12 Demo Day and the Week 6 mid-program soft pitch checkpoint — real panel, real feedback, real pressure.

Partner opportunity: Judge panels, investor access, and front-row seats to the most polished products of the cohort.



KEY COMMUNITY MOMENTS

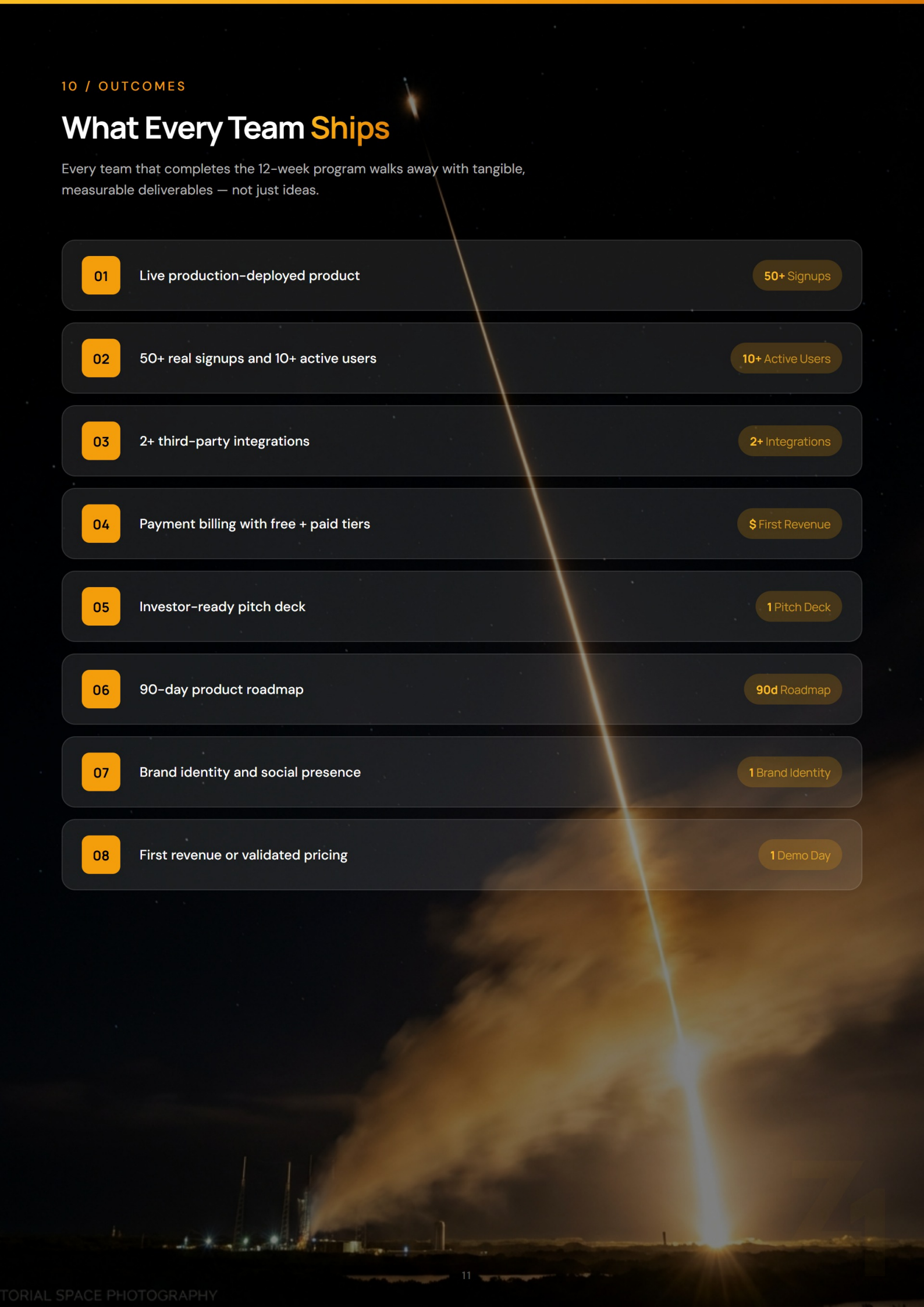
W1	W3	W6	W9	W12
First Grit Chronicles	First Breakpoints.live	Mid-Program Pitch	Launch Broadcast	Demo Day

10 / OUTCOMES

What Every Team Ships

Every team that completes the 12-week program walks away with tangible, measurable deliverables — not just ideas.

01	Live production-deployed product	50+ Signups
02	50+ real signups and 10+ active users	10+ Active Users
03	2+ third-party integrations	2+ Integrations
04	Payment billing with free + paid tiers	$ First Revenue
05	Investor-ready pitch deck	1 Pitch Deck
06	90-day product roadmap	90d Roadmap
07	Brand identity and social presence	1 Brand Identity
08	First revenue or validated pricing	1 Demo Day



TORIAL SPACE PHOTOGRAPHY

11 / PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

Partner With Z-One Forge

Multiple ways to engage with the next generation of builders, whether you're a mentor, corporation, or investor.

Mt

Mentors

Share your expertise directly with founding teams through structured office hours, workshops, and judging panels.

- Weekly 1-on-1 office hours with matched teams
- Lead workshops on your domain expertise
- Judge mid-program and Demo Day pitches
- Access to the SBV mentor network

Cp

Corporate Partners

Tap into a curated pipeline of innovation and emerging talent across multiple industries.

- Sponsor cohort challenges aligned to your industry
- Early access to teams building in your vertical
- Talent pipeline for internships and hires
- Brand visibility across all SBV platforms

Iv

Investors

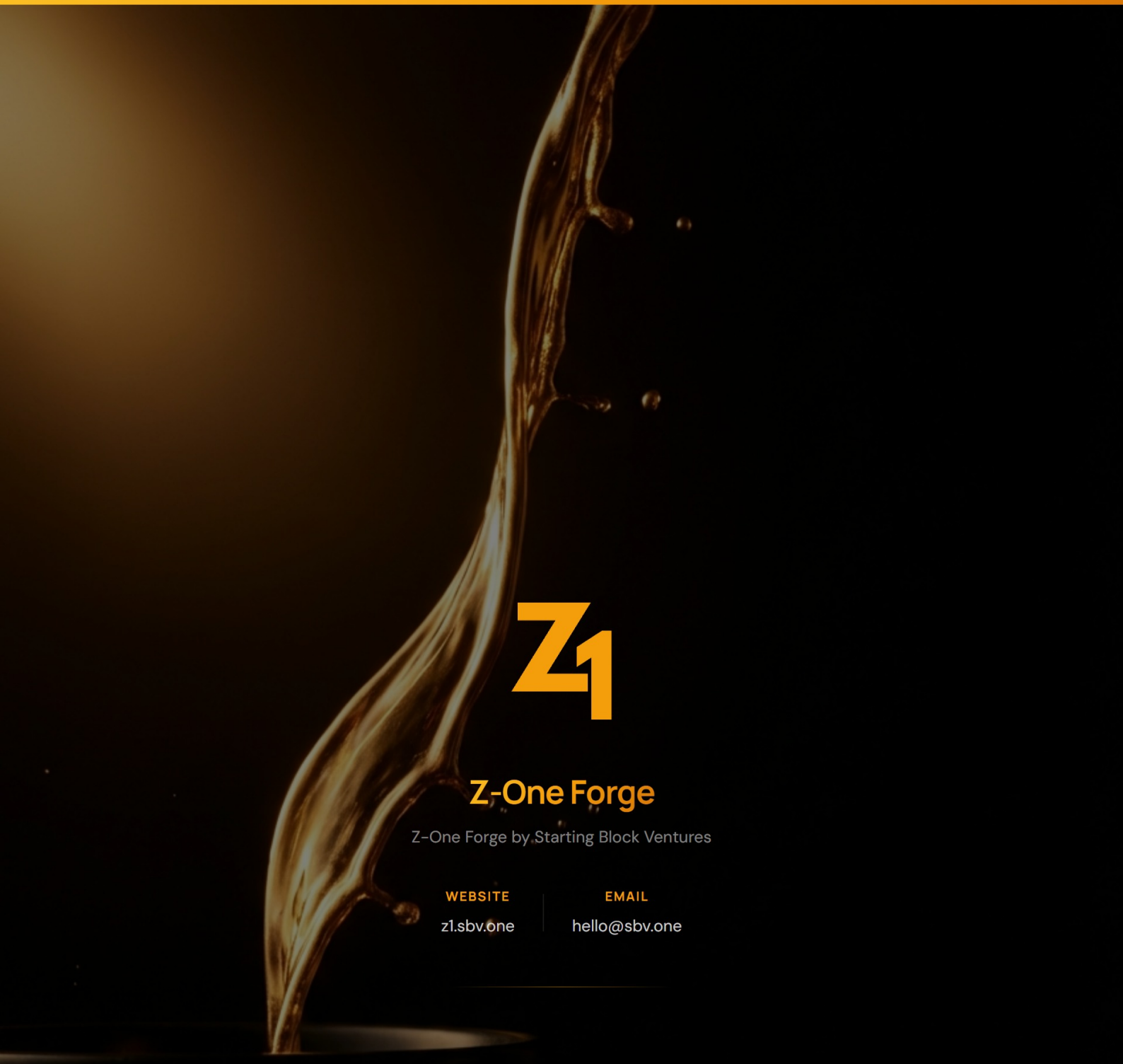
Get front-row access to pre-vetted, product-ready startups before they hit the broader market.

- Demo Day access with live product demos
- Portfolio scouting from Week 1
- Pitch platform visibility for deal flow
- Co-invest opportunities with SBV



CURRENT PARTNERS

StartingBlock VENTURES · DOGM.AI · BULL RUN · break points .live · INCUB8 SPACE. · realboss.ai



Z-One Forge

Z-One Forge by Starting Block Ventures

WEBSITE
z1.sbv.one

EMAIL
hello@sbv.one

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